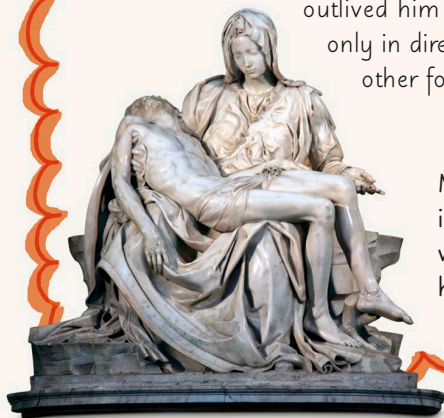


but how many had he actually finished? Even *The Last Supper*, which nobody was questioning as a work of genius, had already begun to deteriorate because of the type of paints Leonardo used and the poor condition of the wall underneath.

MICHELANGELO BUONARROTI

Michelangelo Buonarroti (1475–1564) was born in Florence and was a painter, a sculptor, and an architect. Among his most famous paintings are the ones on the ceiling of the Sistine Chapel in Vatican City, Rome, where the pope lives. His sculptures include the *Pietà* (an Italian word meaning pity or compassion) and *David*. In architecture, he supervised the completion of the western end of St. Peter's Basilica—an important church in Vatican City. Michelangelo was 23 years younger than Leonardo and outlived him by 35 years, so they were only in direct competition with each other for a brief time.



Michelangelo's *Pietà*, which sits in St. Peter's Basilica, Rome, was completed in 1499, when he was only 24 years old.